Establishment (ADE) was born in Bangalore and I was posted to the new establishment.

Bangalore as a city was in direct contrast to Kanpur. In fact, I feel our country has an uncanny way of bringing out extremes in her people. I suppose, it is because Indians have been both afflicted and enriched by centuries of migrations. Loyalty to different rulers has dul ed our capacity for a single al egiance. Instead, we have developed an extraordinary ability to be compassionate and cruel, sensitive and cal ous, deep and fickle, al at the same time. To the untrained eye, we may appear colourful and picturesque; to the critical eye, we are but shoddy imitations of our various masters. In Kanpur, I saw paan-chewing imitations of Wajid Ali Shah, and in Bangalore it was replaced by dog-walking sahibs. Here too, I longed for the depth and calmness of Rameswaram. The relationship between the heart and the head of an earthy Indian has been eroded by the divided sensibilities of our cities. I spent my evenings exploring the gardens and shopping plazas of Bangalore.

The workload at ADE during the first year of its inception was quite light. In fact, I had to generate work for